

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Interdisciplinary Political Analysis - Complete Topic Package

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Interdisciplinary Political Analysis

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1

The Integrated Political Question

2

Definitions, Argument Spine and Purposeful Borrowing

3

Boundaries, Thinkers and Disciplinary Autonomy

4

Illustrations and the Five-Discipline Matrix

5

Trap Repair, Cross-Links, Revision and Sources

6

Anthropology, Law and Geography

7

Borrowed Models and Named Reductionisms

8

Objections and Integration Without Merger

9

Cautious Indian Application

10

Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Interdisciplinary Political Analysis - Complete Topic Package

Subject: Political Theory **Section:** Subject-wide Syllabus **Generation:** learner-v2:g2 **Ownership:** supplementary conceptual support; no synthetic GS or Optional PYQ ownership is created. **Source policy:** complete Basic owner first; optional Advanced depth only after practice.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS ANCHOR - INDIA'S SDG INDICATOR FRAMEWORK

FACT: Fact (MoSPI/PIB, 29 June 2026): On the twentieth Statistics Day, the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation released the *Sustainable Development Goals - National Indicator Framework Progress Report, 2026*. It presents national time-series evidence for monitoring all seventeen SDGs and is intended for policymakers, planners and researchers.

ANALYSIS: Political-theory use: The framework illustrates interdisciplinary evidence because development monitoring connects economic, social, demographic, environmental and institutional indicators. The indicators do not settle political priorities by themselves: selection, weighting, distribution and accountability still require institutional analysis and normative judgment.

Official PIB source: <https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2279014®=6&lang=1> **Official MoSPI report:** <https://www.mospi.gov.in/publication/sustainable-development-goals-national-indicator-framework-progress-report-2026>

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

SESSION 1 - The Integrated Political Question

Subject: Political Theory | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS/Optional relevance:** GS-II (Polity & Governance) conceptual foundation; PSIR Optional Paper-1 background. **Core area:** What history, economics, sociology, psychology and philosophy each contribute to political analysis without replacing political theory itself. **Grounded in:** O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.5, PDF pp.135-146. **Source edition/cutoff:** Fifth Edition (2009); no post-2009 fact is assumed unless independently dated and tagged CURRENT:. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference/synthesis | **CURRENT:** = dated current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap/misattribution. *Companion:* Political-Theory/advanced/09_Interdisciplinary-Political-Analysis.md.

1. One-screen conceptual map

POLITICAL QUESTION

```
|
+--> HISTORY --> roots, sequences, verification over time
+--> ECONOMICS --> production, distribution, conflict over resources
+--> SOCIOLOGY --> groups, institutions, status, political culture
+--> PSYCHOLOGY --> attitudes, personality, propaganda, leadership
+--> PHILOSOPHY --> concepts, values, ends, moral evaluation
|
```

v

INTEGRATED POLITICAL ANALYSIS

```
|
+--> explains facts better
+--> tests claims against wider evidence
+--> keeps politics as the main focus
```

FACT: Gauba defines an interdisciplinary approach as relying on more than one discipline for a given problem and drawing on related disciplines where phenomena overlap. (PDF p.136)

2. Why this topic matters

- **FACT:** Political science studies politics as a social process, so it must use findings, theories and models from other social sciences where they illuminate political phenomena. (PDF pp.136-137)

- **FACT:** Interdisciplinary inquiry widens perspective, helps verify political claims through other social sciences, and also enables political science to contribute back to them. (PDF p.137)
- **FACT:** The chapter argues that single-discipline approaches are partial, whereas an interdisciplinary approach seeks an integrated view of politics. (PDF p.146)
- **ANALYSIS:** For UPSC, this topic prevents shallow answers that explain democracy, state action or mass behaviour through only law, only morality or only economics.

SESSION 2 - Definitions, Argument Spine and Purposeful Borrowing

3. Essential definitions

Term	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Discipline	A branch or field of learning. (PDF p.136)
FACT: Interdisciplinary approach	Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved. (PDF p.136)
FACT: Empirical approach	Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction. (PDF p.138)
FACT: Normative approach	Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done. (PDF p.138)
FACT: Political economy	Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions. (PDF p.143)
FACT: Political sociology	Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought. (PDF p.144)
FACT: Political psychology	Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda. (PDF p.145)
FACT: Political philosophy	Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems. (PDF p.146)

4. Core argument / chapter spine

1. **FACT:** Gauba begins by treating social sciences as related disciplines dealing with common human problems, which makes interdisciplinarity especially suitable to politics. (PDF p.136)
2. **FACT:** He insists that political inquiry should borrow from other disciplines purposefully, always to understand political problems, not randomly for their own sake. (PDF p.137)
3. **FACT:** Empirical orientation, behavioural analysis and systems analysis pushed political science toward other social sciences because real politics cannot be grasped by ideal-state speculation or formal institutions alone. (PDF pp.138-139)
4. **FACT:** Political science therefore uses data, theories and models from history, economics, sociology, psychology and philosophy. (PDF pp.139-146)
5. **FACT:** Yet the conclusion is not merger into one master science; the integrated approach keeps politics central while using all relevant disciplines for verification and understanding. (PDF p.146)

SESSION 3 - Boundaries, Thinkers and Disciplinary Autonomy

5. Essential distinctions

- **FACT: Interdisciplinary vs random borrowing:** Gauba warns that expansion across disciplines must be purposeful and well-conceived. (PDF p.137)
- **FACT: Empirical vs normative:** empirical inquiry asks what is; normative inquiry asks what ought to be. (PDF p.138)
- **FACT: Political science vs political philosophy:** scientific-behavioural studies help find facts and tools, while political philosophy helps determine goals of public policy. (PDF pp.145-146)

- **WRONG: Interdisciplinary = dissolving political theory into economics or sociology.** Gauba rejects this; the approach integrates relevant disciplines but does not merge them into one master science. (PDF p.146)
- **ANALYSIS: Governance boundary:** governance explains delivery mechanisms; this topic uses governance-like evidence only when it sharpens a political concept.
- **ANALYSIS: Economy boundary:** economics explains market and production mechanisms; political theory uses it to understand conflict, welfare, class and policy choice, not to replace economics as a discipline.

6. Thinkers and positions

- **FACT: Aristotle:** the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis. (PDF p.146)
- **FACT: Marx and Engels:** Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure. (PDF p.137)
- **FACT: Heinz Eulau:** political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context. (PDF p.139)
- **FACT: Seymour Martin Lipset:** political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations. (PDF p.140)
- **FACT: Auguste Comte:** science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy. (PDF p.145)

SESSION 4 - Illustrations and the Five-Discipline Matrix

7. Illustrative examples

- **FACT:** Gauba says a political scientist assessing whether democracy will be sustained may need data on literacy, income distribution, ownership patterns, religious attitudes, family structure and rural-urban composition. (PDF p.139)
- **FACT:** Labour-management relations or crowd psychology should be studied politically only when they illuminate their impact on politics. (PDF p.137)
- **FACT:** Political development requires understanding social mobilization and value change, not merely constitutions or legal forms. (PDF p.140)
- **FACT:** Political communication, propaganda, charismatic leadership and public opinion formation draw directly on political psychology. (PDF pp.144-145)
- **ANALYSIS:** A good UPSC answer on welfare politics can therefore move from economic scarcity, to class/group conflict, to mass attitudes, and finally to philosophical evaluation of justice.

8. Comparison table

Semantic table split - Discipline

- **Discipline: FACT: History**
- **What it mainly contributes:** Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation. (PDF p.141)
- **Typical political-theory use:** Testing a theory about state formation or democracy against historical cases.
- **Limit if used alone:** **WRONG:** May become mere chronicle if not politically interpreted.
- **Discipline: FACT: Economics**
- **What it mainly contributes:** Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict. (PDF pp.142-143)
- **Typical political-theory use:** Understanding welfare state claims, class conflict, policy choice and political economy.
- **Limit if used alone:** **WRONG:** Cannot by itself settle legitimacy or justice.
- **Discipline: FACT: Sociology**
- **What it mainly contributes:** Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture. (PDF pp.143-144)
- **Typical political-theory use:** Explaining political socialization, cleavage, leadership and legitimacy.

- **Limit if used alone:** WRONG: Risks reducing politics to social structure alone.
- **Discipline:** FACT: **Psychology**
- **What it mainly contributes:** Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal. (PDF pp.144-145)
- **Typical political-theory use:** Explaining extremist appeal, public opinion and charismatic authority.
- **Limit if used alone:** WRONG: Cannot alone explain institutions or economic conflict.
- **Discipline:** FACT: **Philosophy**
- **What it mainly contributes:** Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life. (PDF pp.145-146)
- **Typical political-theory use:** Clarifying liberty, equality, obligation, justice and the goals of policy.
- **Limit if used alone:** WRONG: Without empirical grounding, it can become purely speculative.

SESSION 5 - Trap Repair, Cross-Links, Revision and Sources

9. UPSC traps and corrections

- WRONG: **"Interdisciplinary study means political science has lost its identity."** -> FACT: Gauba says political science remains focused on politics while using other disciplines for broader and better-grounded analysis. (PDF pp.137, 146)
- WRONG: **"Empirical political science made philosophy irrelevant."** -> FACT: Gauba says political philosophy regained prominence after post-behaviouralism and still helps define policy goals. (PDF pp.145-146)
- WRONG: **"History and political science are the same thing."** -> FACT: Gauba treats this older formula as an oversimplification; history is used selectively and critically. (PDF p.141)
- WRONG: **"One discipline can fully explain politics."** -> FACT: The chapter concludes that philosophical, historical, legal, economic, sociological and psychological approaches are partial when used alone. (PDF p.146)

10. Cross-links and boundaries

- FACT: Use `Political-Theory/advanced/09_Interdisciplinary-Political-Analysis.md` for the evidence-routing matrix and direct-book reconstruction of the chapter.
- FACT: Use `Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md` to place this topic beside 01, 08 and later state, power and justice topics in the wider module architecture.
- FACT: Use `Political-Theory/README.md` for the numbered topic map and dated-source discipline for the whole folder.
- ANALYSIS: For economic mechanisms, refer outward to the Economy module in prose rather than reproducing technical economics here.
- ANALYSIS: For delivery and institutional performance, refer outward to the Governance module in prose rather than turning this topic into an administrative note.

11. Revision capsule / answer spine

ANALYSIS: **Answer spine:** Politics is an open, socially embedded process; therefore political analysis must borrow evidence and models from history, economics, sociology, psychology and philosophy, while still keeping the political question at the centre.

- FACT: Define interdisciplinarity as purposeful use of more than one discipline. (PDF p.136)
- FACT: Show why empirical orientation, behaviouralism and systems analysis pushed political science outward. (PDF pp.138-139)
- FACT: Explain the contribution of each major discipline in one line. (PDF pp.141-146)
- FACT: End with Gauba's conclusion: single-discipline approaches are partial; integration is necessary, but merger is not. (PDF p.146)
- ANALYSIS: In Mains, move from **evidence** -> **explanation** -> **normative evaluation**.

- ANALYSIS: In Prelims, remember the paired terms: political economy, political sociology, political psychology, political philosophy.

12. Sources, metadata and tags

- FACT: Primary source used directly: Gauba, Ch.5, especially PDF pp.136-146, with page anchors preserved in the supplied text extraction.
- FACT: The chapter's institutional references to behaviouralism, post-behaviouralism and twentieth-century scholarship are book-period conceptual discussions, not present-day survey findings. (PDF pp.138-146)
- ANALYSIS: This file paraphrases rather than quotes; examples are used only to make the chapter exam-usable.
- FACT: Companion file created in this folder:
Political-Theory/advanced/09_Interdisciplinary-Political-Analysis.md.

SESSION 6 - Anthropology, Law and Geography

13. Extending the discipline list: anthropology, law and geography

- ANALYSIS: Gauba's chapter (PDF pp.141-146) foregrounds history, economics, sociology, psychology and philosophy. A complete interdisciplinary answer should also be able to place anthropology, law and geography on the same map, since these are commonly tested alongside the five above:
- **Political anthropology:** studies political organisation in small-scale, kinship-based or non-state/pre-state societies (lineage systems, tribal councils, chieftaincy) - contributes evidence that authority and order can be organised without a centralised state, which sharpens rather than dissolves the concept of the state used in Political-Theory/basic/10_State-Civil-Society-Nation-and-Internationalism.md.
- **Claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit:** Claim: political order does not require a Weberian state. Evidence: kinship/lineage-based dispute-resolution and authority structures documented across many non-state societies. Significance: tests and refines political theory's core concepts (authority, legitimacy, sovereignty) against non-state cases rather than assuming the modern state is the only unit of analysis. Limit: findings from small-scale societies cannot be mechanically transplanted onto large, complex modern states.
- **Law/jurisprudence as a data source:** distinct from the legal *approach* to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained.
- **Claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit:** Claim: legal materials are indispensable evidence for political analysis of institutions and rights. Evidence: constitutional provisions and case law define formal powers, limits and remedies. Significance: grounds political claims about institutional design in verifiable text rather than impression. Limit: legal text alone cannot explain informal power, bargaining or non-compliance - hence the need for sociology/psychology alongside it.
- **Political geography:** studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography.
- **Claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit:** Claim: where power and resources are located in space shapes political conflict and institutional design. Evidence: boundary disputes, resource-rich/resource-poor regional imbalance, and federal arrangements responding to territorial diversity. Significance: explains regionalism, federalism and centre-state or inter-state conflict that a purely institutional or economic account would miss. Limit: geography constrains but does not determine political outcomes; it must be combined with sociology (identity) and economics (resource conflict) rather than treated as destiny.
- ANALYSIS: Exam use: if the question specifically asks for an "interdisciplinary" answer without naming disciplines, a strong 15/20-mark response should be able to name at least six to seven disciplines (history, economics, sociology, psychology, philosophy, anthropology, law, geography) and give one distinct contribution for each, rather than repeating the same five from Gauba's chapter alone.

SESSION 7 - Borrowed Models and Named Reductionisms

14. Borrowed models and the limits of reductionism (named)

- FACT: Gauba names specific borrowed models political science has drawn from other disciplines: **elite theory**, **base-superstructure analysis** (from Marxian political economy), **structural-functionalism** (from sociology/anthropology), **problem-solving/decision models** (from psychology and organisational theory), and market/bargaining analogies (from economics). (PDF pp.139-140)
- FACT: **David Easton's political-system framework** is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback (see [Political-Theory/basic/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md](#) §15 for the full reconstruction). (PDF p.140)
- FACT: **Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model** is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes. (PDF p.140)
- ANALYSIS: **Reductionism, named precisely:** each borrowed model risks a specific reductionism if used alone -
 - *Economic reductionism* (treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest.
 - *Psychological reductionism* (treating all politics as individual attitude/personality) misses structural, institutional and economic constraints that operate independently of any single actor's psychology.
 - *Sociological/functional reductionism* (treating all politics as social-structure maintenance) risks a conservative bias that under-explains conflict, agency and deliberate institutional change.
 - *Legal reductionism* (treating politics as fully captured by formal rules) misses informal power and non-compliance.
- ANALYSIS: Gauba's own corrective applies to each: borrowing must remain purposeful and politics-centred; a borrowed model sharpens political analysis only so long as the political question, not the donor discipline's own priorities, stays in view. (PDF pp.137, 146)

SESSION 8 - Objections and Integration Without Merger

15. Two objection-reply chains

1. **Objection:** if political science borrows core models from economics, sociology and psychology, it risks losing any distinct subject-matter of its own and dissolving into "social science in general."

Reply: Gauba's own conclusion answers this directly - interdisciplinary borrowing integrates evidence and models from other disciplines but does not merge political science into any one of them; the political question (who gets valued things, through what authoritative process) remains the organising centre even when the evidence used to answer it is economic, sociological or psychological. (PDF p.146)

2. **Objection:** using anthropological or geographical evidence risks importing findings from very different (small-scale, or purely spatial) contexts and over-generalising them to modern, large-scale democratic states.

Reply: the reply is the same discipline-by-discipline caution the chapter already applies to history and economics: such evidence is used for *testing and illustrating* a political claim (e.g. that authority need not be state-centred, or that territory shapes conflict), not for asserting that small-scale or purely spatial patterns transfer mechanically to a different scale of politics - each discipline's evidence is weighed for relevance, not imported wholesale. ANALYSIS: This reply is a reasonable extension of Gauba's own purposeful-borrowing standard, not a direct book quotation.

SESSION 9 - Cautious Indian Application

16. Cautious Indian application

- ANALYSIS: Political-economy lens: debates on economic liberalisation, welfare-scheme design or federal fiscal transfers illustrate how political theory uses economic evidence to analyse policy conflict - cite as a *type* of application, without asserting specific unverified figures, scheme names or years unless independently confirmed.
- ANALYSIS: Political-sociology lens: caste, community and regional identity's role in Indian party mobilisation and political culture is a standard illustrative anchor for the sociology-politics link - use only as a general, well-known pattern, not with specific unverified electoral statistics.
- ANALYSIS: Political-geography lens: India's federal reorganisation of states and continuing regional/resource-sharing disputes (river-water disputes, hill-state demands) illustrate how territory and resource distribution shape political conflict - cite as a *type* of illustration; route exact dates, tribunal names or case detail to the Polity/Geography modules rather than asserting them here.

SESSION 10 - Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture

17. Executable answer architecture (10/15/20 marks)

Directive decoding

- "Discuss the interdisciplinary character of political science" -> requires the definition of interdisciplinarity, at least three disciplines with one contribution each, and the integration-without-merger conclusion - not just a list of subject names.
- "Examine the contribution of [a named discipline] to political analysis" -> single-discipline directive: give that discipline's specific contribution, one borrowed model or example, and its limit if used alone.
- "Can political science be studied independently of other social sciences?" -> requires the objection/reply on subject-matter dissolution (§15.1) explicitly.

10-mark architecture (~150 words)

1. Thesis: political science needs other disciplines' evidence and models but keeps the political question central.
2. Body: name 2-3 disciplines with one contribution each (claim->evidence->significance).
3. One limit/reductionism risk.
4. One-line conclusion.

15-mark architecture (~200-250 words)

1. Thesis + directive decoding.
2. Doctrine reconstruction: definition of interdisciplinarity -> why empirical/behavioural/systems analysis pushed political science outward -> 4-5 disciplines (including at least one of anthropology/law/geography) each with claim->evidence->significance->limit.
3. Name one borrowed model (Easton's system, or Lasswell's problem-solving model).
4. One objection-reply chain.
5. Reasoned conclusion (integration without merger).

20-mark architecture (~250-300 words)

1. Thesis + directive decoding.
2. Full doctrine reconstruction across history, economics, sociology, psychology, philosophy, plus anthropology, law and geography, each with claim->evidence->significance->limit.
3. Name at least two borrowed models explicitly (Easton's systems framework, Lasswell's problem-solving model, or elite theory/base-superstructure analysis) and state the specific reductionism risk for each donor discipline.
4. Two objection-reply chains (dissolution-of-subject-matter objection; over-generalisation-from-small-scale-or-spatial-evidence objection).
5. Cautious Indian application (one example, correctly hedged).

6. Graded conclusion: integration deepens explanation; merger is neither possible nor desirable.

Quotation/proposition method

- Prefer paraphrased, named propositions over unverified quotations, e.g. "*Gauba's proposition that interdisciplinary borrowing must remain purposeful and politics-centred*" rather than an exact quoted sentence, unless independently verified.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Discipline**?

A. A branch or field of learning. B. Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought. C. Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture. D. studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Discipline** with **A branch or field of learning**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A branch or field of learning**.

A. Aristotle B. Discipline C. David Easton's political-system framework D. Empirical approach

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A branch or field of learning**. with **Discipline**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Interdisciplinary approach**?

A. Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda. B. Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal. C. Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved. D. the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Interdisciplinary approach** with **Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved**.

A. Marx and Engels B. Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model C. Normative approach D. Interdisciplinary approach

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved**. with **Interdisciplinary approach**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Empirical approach**?

A. Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction. B. Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems. C. Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life. D. Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Empirical approach** with **Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.**

A. Heinz Eulau B. Empirical approach C. Economic reductionism D. Political economy

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.** with **Empirical approach.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Normative approach?**

A. Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation. B. political order does not require a Weberian state. C. Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done. D. political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Normative approach** with **Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.**

A. Seymour Martin Lipset B. Discipline C. Political sociology D. Normative approach

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.** with **Normative approach.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political economy?**

A. Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions. B. Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict. C. distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained. D. political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political economy** with **Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions.**

A. Auguste Comte B. Political economy C. Interdisciplinary approach D. Political psychology

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions.** with **Political economy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political sociology**?

A. Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture. B. studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography. C. Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought. D. science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political sociology** with **Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.**

A. David Easton's political-system framework B. Empirical approach C. Political philosophy D. Political sociology

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.** with **Political sociology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political psychology**?

A. Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda. B. Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal. C. the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis. D. is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback .

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political psychology** with **Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.**

A. Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model B. Political psychology C. Normative approach D. History

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.** with **Political psychology.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political philosophy**?

A. Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life. B. Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure. C. Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems. D. is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political philosophy** with **Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.**

A. Economic reductionism B. Political economy C. Economics D. Political philosophy

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.** with **Political philosophy.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **History**?

A. Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation. B. political order does not require a Weberian state. C. political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context. D. (treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **History** with **Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.**

A. Discipline B. History C. Political sociology D. Sociology

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.** with **History.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Economics**?

A. distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary

evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained. B. political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations. C. Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict. D. A branch or field of learning.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Economics** with **Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict**.

A. Interdisciplinary approach B. Political psychology C. Psychology D. Economics

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict** with **Economics**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Sociology**?

A. Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture. B. studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography. C. science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy. D. Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sociology** with **Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture**.

A. Empirical approach B. Sociology C. Political philosophy D. Philosophy

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture** with **Sociology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Psychology**?

A. the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis. B. is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback. C. Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal. D. Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Psychology** with **Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.**

A. Normative approach B. History C. Political anthropology D. Psychology

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.** with **Psychology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Philosophy**?

A. Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life. B. Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure. C. is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes. D. Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Philosophy** with **Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.**

A. Political economy B. Philosophy C. Economics D. Law/jurisprudence as a data source

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.** with **Philosophy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political anthropology**?

A. political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context. B. (treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest. C. political order does not require a Weberian state. D. Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political anthropology** with **political order does not require a Weberian state..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **political order does not require a Weberian state.**

A. Political sociology B. Sociology C. Political geography D. Political anthropology

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **political order does not require a Weberian state.** with **Political anthropology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Law/jurisprudence as a data source**?

A. distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained. B. political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations. C. A branch or field of learning. D. Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Law/jurisprudence as a data source** with **distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained.**

A. Political psychology B. Law/jurisprudence as a data source C. Psychology D. Aristotle

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained.** with **Law/jurisprudence as a data source**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political geography**?

A. science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy. B. Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved. C. studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography. D. Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political geography** with **studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography.**

A. Political philosophy B. Philosophy C. Marx and Engels D. Political geography

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography.** with **Political geography**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Aristotle**?

A. the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis. B. is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback. C. Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction. D. Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Aristotle** with **the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis.**

A. History B. Aristotle C. Political anthropology D. Heinz Eulau

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis.** with **Aristotle**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Marx and Engels**?

A. is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes. B. Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done. C. Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure. D. Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marx and Engels** with **Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure.**

A. Economics B. Law/jurisprudence as a data source C. Seymour Martin Lipset D. Marx and Engels

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure.** with **Marx and Engels**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Heinz Eulau**?

A. political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context. B. (treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest. C. Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making

and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions. D. Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Heinz Eulau** with **political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context.**

A. Sociology B. Heinz Eulau C. Political geography D. Auguste Comte

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context.** with **Heinz Eulau**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Seymour Martin Lipset**?

A. A branch or field of learning. B. Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought. C. political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations. D. Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Seymour Martin Lipset** with **political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations.**

A. Psychology B. Aristotle C. David Easton's political-system framework D. Seymour Martin Lipset

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations.** with **Seymour Martin Lipset**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Auguste Comte**?

A. science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy. B. Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved. C. Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda. D. Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Auguste Comte** with **science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy.**

A. Philosophy B. Auguste Comte C. Marx and Engels D. Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy.** with **Auguste Comte**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **David Easton's political-system framework?**

A. Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction. B. Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems. C. is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback . D. Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **David Easton's political-system framework** with **is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback .** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback .**

A. Political anthropology B. Heinz Eulau C. Economic reductionism D. David Easton's political-system framework

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback .** with **David Easton's political-system framework**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model?**

A. is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes. B. Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done. C. Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation. D. political order does not require a Weberian state.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model** with **is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes.**

A. Law/jurisprudence as a data source B. Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model C. Seymour Martin Lipset D. Discipline

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes.** with **Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Economic reductionism**?

A. Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions. B. Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict. C. (treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest. D. distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Economic reductionism** with **(treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **(treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest.**

A. Political geography B. Auguste Comte C. Interdisciplinary approach D. Economic reductionism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **(treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest.** with **Economic reductionism.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ STATUS

No directly owned verified UPSC PYQ is assigned to this Political Theory topic. Political Theory is a conceptual-support repository, and the source mapping expressly prohibits proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ routing. The questions below are therefore labelled as original practice, not PYQs.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Define interdisciplinary political analysis and explain why borrowing must remain purposeful and politics-centred. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Interdisciplinary political analysis uses evidence, concepts or models from more than one discipline to investigate overlapping social phenomena.

Core analysis: Politics is embedded in economic, social, historical, psychological, legal and spatial environments. Political science therefore borrows when another discipline supplies evidence needed to explain a political question. History tests sequences, economics identifies material interests, sociology maps groups, psychology examines attitudes, and philosophy evaluates ends. Gauba's qualification is essential: labour relations, kinship or crowd behaviour enter political analysis only insofar as they illuminate power, authority, conflict, legitimacy or policy. Borrowing is purposeful when the political problem determines what is selected and how it is interpreted.

Critical evaluation: Random borrowing can produce an impressive list without explanation, while merger into a master science erases distinct questions and standards. Interdisciplinarity should widen verification and causal depth while keeping political judgment as the organising task.

Conclusion: Interdisciplinarity deepens political explanation only when borrowed evidence answers a clearly political question; random accumulation of neighbouring knowledge produces diffusion rather than integration.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Explain how history and economics contribute differently to political analysis. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: History and economics enrich political inquiry through different types of evidence and explanation.

Core analysis: History supplies sequences, antecedents, comparisons and long-term patterns. It tests whether claims about democracy, state formation or conflict survive variation across time and cases, but becomes mere chronicle if events are not politically interpreted. Economics examines production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and incentives. Political economy uses these mechanisms to explain class conflict, welfare choices, public control and how economic demands shape state decisions. It exposes material constraints that formal institutional analysis may overlook.

Critical evaluation: Neither discipline is sufficient alone. Historical recurrence does not establish present moral worth, and economic interest does not exhaust identity, legitimacy or obligation. Political analysis must interpret historical evidence and economic mechanisms through institutions, power relations and normative standards.

Conclusion: History tests political claims across time and sequence, while economics explains material incentives and distributional conflict; neither can independently settle legitimacy or justice.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Can political science be studied independently of the other social sciences? Discuss. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Political science has a distinct organising concern with power, authority, conflict and binding collective decisions, but its subject matter cannot be isolated from wider social life.

Core analysis: Gauba identifies three interdisciplinary functions: political science uses findings from related disciplines, verifies its theories through their evidence and contributes political insight back to them. History supplies temporal testing; economics explains resources and incentives; sociology identifies groups and institutions; psychology studies attitudes and leadership; philosophy clarifies values and ends. Behavioural and systems approaches intensified this exchange by shifting attention from formal government to actors and to the political system's environment. Yet borrowing does not abolish disciplinary identity, because the political question determines relevance.

Further development: The claim of autonomy must therefore be specified. Political science is autonomous in selecting and organising questions about collective power, but dependent in the evidential sense that those questions unfold through economies, social structures, personalities, histories and moral vocabularies. Interdisciplinary exchange is reciprocal rather than one-way: political institutions and decisions also reshape markets, identities and

behaviour. This avoids both disciplinary isolation and the opposite error of treating politics as merely an effect generated elsewhere.

Critical evaluation: A completely independent political science would become formally narrow or normatively abstract. Complete merger would be equally mistaken. The defensible position is autonomy through integration: a distinct political focus supported by multiple bodies of evidence.

Conclusion: Political science retains an autonomous organising question about power and authoritative allocation, but credible answers require evidence and models from the wider social sciences.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Examine the contributions and limits of sociology and psychology in political analysis. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Sociology and psychology correct institutional accounts by explaining the social structures and individual processes through which politics is lived.

Core analysis: Political sociology studies groups, status, norms, participation, leadership, political culture and the relation between social structures and political institutions. It explains why similar constitutional forms may operate differently across societies. Political psychology studies attitudes, learning, personality, propaganda, public opinion and charismatic or extremist appeal. It helps reconstruct how citizens and leaders perceive choices and acquire political orientations. Eulau's contextual account and Lipset's emphasis on mobilisation, values, kinship and class illustrate why behaviour cannot be detached from its environment.

Further development: Their explanatory levels can be connected through mechanisms. Social structures influence the identities, incentives and information available to actors; psychological processes shape how those conditions are perceived and acted upon; institutions then aggregate or constrain the resulting conduct. This sequence avoids simply listing variables. It also shows why neither approach can establish the legitimacy of an outcome: evaluation of domination, justice or responsibility requires political philosophy in addition to causal explanation.

Critical evaluation: Sociological reductionism may turn politics into passive maintenance of social structure, underplaying agency and deliberate institutional change. Psychological reductionism may individualise outcomes produced by class, law or organisation. The two disciplines contribute most when linked to each other and to political institutions.

Conclusion: Sociology and psychology reveal social structure and individual motivation respectively, but political explanation requires both levels to be connected to institutions, resources and normative judgment.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Evaluate the interdisciplinary approach to political analysis with reference to major disciplines and borrowed models. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Interdisciplinary political analysis responds to the fact that political action occurs within overlapping historical, economic, social, psychological and normative environments.

Core analysis: History verifies claims through sequences and cases; economics reveals scarcity, production and distribution; sociology explains groups, norms and participation; psychology studies attitudes, learning and leadership; philosophy clarifies obligation, justice and policy ends. Anthropology tests state-centred assumptions through non-state authority, law supplies formal texts and judicial reasoning, and geography reveals the territorial distribution of power and resources. Political science also borrows models: Easton's system comes from general systems thinking, structural-functionalism from sociology and anthropology, Lasswell's problem-solving orientation from psychology and decision theory, and base-superstructure analysis from political economy.

Further development: A full evaluation must distinguish data from models and explanation from evaluation. Literacy, income, kinship, attitudes, legal rules and regional distribution are data drawn from different disciplines; systems, structural-functional, market, elite and problem-solving frameworks organise causal interpretation. Philosophy then asks whether the resulting institutions and policies are justified. The approach is not automatically superior merely because it contains more variables. Explanations become incoherent when causal levels are mixed or evidence is imported without relevance. A strong interdisciplinary design therefore begins with a political question, identifies the missing evidence, specifies how each discipline changes the hypothesis and ends with an integrated rather than additive judgment.

Critical evaluation: Every borrowing carries reductionist risk. Material, social, psychological, legal or spatial variables can be mistaken for complete explanations. Gauba's remedy is integrated verification without merger and purposeful retention of the political question.

Conclusion: Interdisciplinary analysis is strongest as structured integration: multiple disciplines correct one another's blind spots while the political problem remains the organising centre.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Does interdisciplinarity deepen or threaten the autonomy of political science? Critically discuss. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Interdisciplinarity appears to threaten autonomy because political science borrows much of its evidence and many models from neighbouring disciplines.

Core analysis: The threat is real when economics reduces politics to bargaining or class, psychology to personality, sociology to system maintenance, law to formal rules, or geography to spatial destiny. A discipline that merely aggregates these accounts loses a distinct explanatory task. Yet political science asks a question none of them settles alone: how power, authority and conflict produce collectively binding decisions and how those decisions should be judged. History, economics, sociology, psychology, philosophy, anthropology, law and geography then become evidence routes organised around that problem. Borrowed models such as Easton's system or Lasswell's problem-solving framework remain political when adapted to political actors, institutions and consequences.

Further development: The Indian application can remain conceptual. Analysis of democratic durability may combine historical institution-building, economic inequality, caste or community structures, mass attitudes, constitutional law and territorial diversity. The 29 June 2026 release of MoSPI's SDG National Indicator Framework Progress Report offers a current evidence anchor because it organises time-series indicators across all seventeen SDGs for monitoring and policy. Such a framework illustrates interdisciplinary evidence, not a self-interpreting political conclusion. Indicator selection, distributional priorities, accountability and the meaning of development still require political and philosophical judgment. The example therefore supports autonomy through integration rather than government by data alone.

Critical evaluation: Autonomy therefore means control of the organising question, not insulation from evidence. Purposeful integration deepens political science; uncritical merger or single-discipline reduction threatens it.

Conclusion: Interdisciplinarity deepens rather than dissolves political science when borrowing is selective, reductionism is resisted and the discipline retains responsibility for political explanation and evaluation.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Political Theory | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS/Optional relevance:** GS-II (Polity & Governance) conceptual foundation; PSIR Optional Paper-1 background. **Core area:** Reconstructing Gauba's case for interdisciplinarity as a method of verification, explanation and evaluation in political analysis. **Grounded in:** O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.5, PDF pp.135-146. **Source edition/cutoff:** Fifth Edition (2009); no post-2009 fact is assumed unless independently dated and tagged CURRENT:. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference/synthesis | **CURRENT:** = dated current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap/misattribution. **Companion:** Political-Theory/basic/09_Interdisciplinary-Political-Analysis.md.

1. One-screen advanced map

POLITICAL CLAIM

```
|
+--> HISTORICAL CHECK: did it hold across time/cases?
+--> ECONOMIC CHECK: what resource conflicts and incentives shape it?
+--> SOCIOLOGICAL CHECK: what groups, norms and structures carry it?
+--> PSYCHOLOGICAL CHECK: what attitudes, fears and identities sustain it?
+--> PHILOSOPHICAL CHECK: is it conceptually clear and normatively defensible?
|
v
```

INTEGRATED POLITICAL JUDGMENT

= explanation + verification + evaluation

FACT: Gauba's conclusion is that political inquiry should be based on and verified from all relevant social sciences, not on a single partial approach. (PDF p.146)

2. Scope, assumptions and conceptual boundary

- **FACT:** The chapter treats politics as a social process and the political system as an open system linked to a wider social environment. (PDF pp.137-139)
- **FACT:** Interdisciplinarity here means selective, purposive borrowing directed toward political understanding, not intellectual tourism across disciplines. (PDF p.137)
- **WRONG:** It does **not** mean that political theory is absorbed into economics, sociology or psychology; Gauba explicitly rejects merger into a single master science. (PDF p.146)
- **ANALYSIS:** This file therefore stays at the level of concept-routing: how a political theorist chooses evidence and checks arguments.
- **ANALYSIS:** Boundary rule: governance can illustrate administrative consequences, and economics can explain material mechanisms, but this topic is about how those inputs are used in political analysis.

3. Direct-book argument reconstruction

1. **FACT:** Gauba first defines disciplines and then marks the social sciences as especially suited to interdisciplinary work because they study overlapping aspects of human society. (PDF p.136)
2. **FACT:** He then specifies three functions of interdisciplinarity in political science: use other disciplines' findings, verify political theories through them, and contribute back to their understanding. (PDF p.137)
3. **FACT:** He warns that such widening must remain focused on politics; labour relations or crowd psychology matter here only insofar as they affect political outcomes. (PDF p.137)
4. **FACT:** The methodological push comes from empirical orientation: observable facts, causal explanation, generalization and prediction displaced purely ideal-state speculation. (PDF p.138)
5. **FACT:** Behavioural analysis widened the unit of study from formal institutions to the behaviour of voters, elites, bureaucrats, judges and groups. (PDF pp.138-139)
6. **FACT:** Systems analysis further required study of inputs, outputs and feedback between political and social systems. (PDF p.137, PDF p.139)
7. **FACT:** Political science thus began using other disciplines' data, theories and models, including elite theory, base-superstructure analysis, structural-functionalism, problem-solving models and market analogies. (PDF pp.139-140)

8. FACT: Gauba then demonstrates the specific uses of history, economics, sociology, psychology and philosophy for political analysis. (PDF pp.141-146)
9. FACT: He ends by saying single-discipline approaches remain partial, while the interdisciplinary approach aims at an integrated view without abolishing disciplinary boundaries. (PDF p.146)

4. Definitions and distinctions

Pair	Advanced distinction
FACT: Empirical / Normative	Empirical inquiry explains what exists through facts and causal relations; normative inquiry evaluates what ought to be through values and standards. (PDF p.138)
FACT: Political science / Political philosophy	Political science helps discover facts and operational tools; political philosophy clarifies goals, obligation, justice and the moral worth of systems. (PDF pp.145-146)
FACT: Interdisciplinary / Single-discipline	Interdisciplinary analysis checks a political claim against multiple relevant bodies of evidence; single-discipline analysis remains partial. (PDF p.146)
FACT: Use of data / Use of models	Data include literacy, income distribution, kinship patterns and attitudes; models include elite theory, structural-functionalism and economic bargaining analogies. (PDF pp.139-140)
WRONG: Broader scope / Loss of focus	Gauba permits broader scope only when the main focus remains political. (PDF p.137)

5. Thinker-by-thinker positions

- FACT: **Aristotle**: the classical "master science" image blurred normative and empirical aspects and did not sharply separate politics from wider social life. (PDF p.146)
- FACT: **Marx and Engels**: early systematic interdisciplinarians because they related politics to technology, production and class structure. (PDF p.137)
- FACT: **Heinz Eulau**: political behaviour must be studied within wider social, cultural and personal contexts. (PDF p.139)
- FACT: **Seymour Martin Lipset**: political development depends on social mobilization, value change, kinship structure and class/status relations. (PDF p.140)
- FACT: **Auguste Comte**: science itself emerges from philosophical foundations; Gauba uses this to soften a rigid philosophy/science divide. (PDF p.145)
- FACT: **David Easton**: his political-system framework is borrowed from sociology, showing direct interdisciplinary transfer into political science. (PDF p.140)
- FACT: **Harold Lasswell**: Gauba cites the problem-solving model as an example of psychology feeding political analysis. (PDF p.140)

6. Competing perspectives

- FACT: **Historical perspective**: treats the past as a storehouse of data and causal patterns for political verification. (PDF p.141)
- FACT: **Political-economic perspective**: looks at production, distribution, exchange, economic demands and the state's role in reconciling them. (PDF pp.142-143)
- FACT: **Political-sociological perspective**: studies the political subsystem in relation to social structures, norms, leadership and participation. (PDF pp.143-144)
- FACT: **Political-psychological perspective**: explains attitudes, personality, learning, propaganda and extremist appeal. (PDF pp.144-145)
- FACT: **Political-philosophical perspective**: clarifies ends, values, obligation, good life and the moral standing of political systems. (PDF pp.145-146)

- ANALYSIS: These are best seen as complementary lenses: explanation improves when their evidence is combined rather than ranked in a fixed hierarchy.

7. Internal debates and criticisms

- FACT: Gauba notes older claims like "history is past politics" as oversimplifications because political science has gained an independent identity. (PDF p.141)
- FACT: He also presents the science/philosophy split as exaggerated because science itself originates in philosophy and still requires philosophical validation of ends. (PDF p.145)
- WRONG: **Economic reductionism**: Marxian or market models can illuminate politics, but the chapter does not say economics alone settles political analysis. (PDF pp.140, 142-143, 146)
- WRONG: **Behaviouralist reductionism**: focus on observable behaviour corrected older formalism, but Gauba also records the later revival of justice, liberty, equality and community. (PDF pp.145-146)
- ANALYSIS: A useful criticism of pure interdisciplinarity is diffusion of focus; Gauba pre-empts this by insisting on purposeful relevance to politics. (PDF p.137)

8. Comparative matrix

Evidence-routing matrix

Semantic table split - Route

- **Route: FACT: Historical verification**
- **What it contributes**: Past cases, sequences, roots and patterns. (PDF p.141)
- **What it verifies or clarifies**: Whether a political theory survives rule-and-exception testing. (PDF p.141)
- **Example political-theory use**: Testing claims about democracy, state formation or international conflict.
- **What it cannot settle alone**: WRONG: Present moral worth of a system.
- **Route: FACT: Political economy**
- **What it contributes**: Production, distribution, exchange, resource conflict and policy incentives. (PDF pp.142-143)
- **What it verifies or clarifies**: Whether material interests and economic demands explain political conflict or policy. (PDF pp.142-143)
- **Example political-theory use**: Welfare state, class conflict, planning, public control, development.
- **What it cannot settle alone**: WRONG: Full account of legitimacy or civic identity.
- **Route: FACT: Political sociology**
- **What it contributes**: Social structures, status, values, institutions, participation and leadership. (PDF pp.143-144)
- **What it verifies or clarifies**: Whether a political arrangement fits the social basis that sustains it. (PDF pp.139, 143-144)
- **Example political-theory use**: Political culture, socialization, group conflict, legitimacy.
- **What it cannot settle alone**: WRONG: Inner motive of a specific actor or final normative judgment.
- **Route: FACT: Political psychology**
- **What it contributes**: Attitudes, personality, learning, propaganda and leadership style. (PDF pp.144-145)
- **What it verifies or clarifies**: Whether mass appeal, obedience or extremism can be traced to psychological mechanisms. (PDF pp.144-145)
- **Example political-theory use**: Authoritarian personality, charisma, public opinion, propaganda.
- **What it cannot settle alone**: WRONG: Structural class or institutional explanation by itself.
- **Route: FACT: Philosophical clarification/evaluation**
- **What it contributes**: Conceptual clarity, ends, values and moral appraisal. (PDF pp.145-146)
- **What it verifies or clarifies**: Whether concepts like justice, liberty or obligation are coherent and defensible. (PDF pp.145-146)
- **Example political-theory use**: Evaluating policy goals or the moral worth of political systems.
- **What it cannot settle alone**: WRONG: Standalone explanation of actual behaviour without empirical evidence.

9. Application without current-affairs dependence

- ANALYSIS: **Hypothetical 1:** "Why does one democracy survive while another collapses?" -> route through history for antecedents, economics for inequality, sociology for cleavages, psychology for authoritarian appeal, and philosophy for legitimacy.
- ANALYSIS: **Hypothetical 2:** "Should a state regulate markets for welfare?" -> route through economics for incentives and distribution, sociology for class effects, and philosophy for justice and common good.
- ANALYSIS: **Hypothetical 3:** "Why do citizens obey harmful propaganda?" -> route through psychology for attitude formation, sociology for group identity, and philosophy for truth and responsibility.
- ANALYSIS: The point is not to pile disciplines mechanically, but to ask which discipline supplies the missing evidence in a political argument.

10. UPSC answer-engine prompts

- ANALYSIS: **Prompt frame 1:** Define interdisciplinarity -> show empirical/behavioural push -> map five disciplines -> conclude with integration without merger.
- ANALYSIS: **Prompt frame 2:** If the question mentions political behaviour, immediately bring in sociology and psychology before discussing institutions.
- ANALYSIS: **Prompt frame 3:** If the question mentions justice, liberty or obligation, add philosophy explicitly instead of writing only empirical explanation.
- ANALYSIS: **Practice prompt:** "Why are single-cause theories of politics analytically weak?"
- ANALYSIS: **Practice prompt:** "How does interdisciplinarity deepen but not destroy the autonomy of political theory?"

11. Cross-links and exclusions

- FACT: Companion file: `Political-Theory/basic/09_Interdisciplinary-Political-Analysis.md`.
- FACT: Wider frame: `Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md`.
- FACT: Folder method and tag policy: `Political-Theory/README.md`.
- FACT: The chapter naturally looks backward to behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism; use `Political-Theory/advanced/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md` for that companion depth.
- ANALYSIS: The chapter also points outward to economics and governance as neighbouring domains; this file does not reproduce full economic theory or administrative case detail.

12. Factual-risk checks

- FACT: References to behaviouralism, post-behaviouralism and cited scholars belong to Gauba's 2009 exposition of twentieth-century debates. (PDF pp.138-146)
- FACT: Statements about what history, economics, sociology, psychology and philosophy contribute are source-grounded chapter summaries, not present-day disciplinary consensus claims beyond the book. (PDF pp.141-146)
- WRONG: Do not present Gauba's disciplinary map as if it abolishes legal or geographical approaches; his conclusion is that single approaches are partial, not useless. (PDF p.146)
- WRONG: Do not convert classic examples into current data claims; this chapter is methodological, not a live empirical survey.

13. Sources, metadata and tags

- FACT: Direct source window read in full across the assigned extraction range, with core anchors on PDF pp.136-146.
- FACT: Especially used: approach and method (PDF pp.136-140), history (PDF p.141), economics (PDF pp.142-143), sociology (PDF pp.143-144), psychology (PDF pp.144-145), philosophy and conclusion (PDF pp.145-146).
- ANALYSIS: All tables and answer-prompts are exam-oriented syntheses built from the chapter's explicit structure.
- FACT: Companion path in this folder:
Political-Theory/basic/09_Interdisciplinary-Political-Analysis.md.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

ONE-PAGE CONCEPT GRID

Concept / thinker	Exam-ready formulation
Discipline	A branch or field of learning.
Interdisciplinary approach	Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved.
Empirical approach	Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.
Normative approach	Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.
Political economy	Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions.
Political sociology	Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.
Political psychology	Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.
Political philosophy	Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.
Interdisciplinary vs random borrowing	Gauba warns that expansion across disciplines must be purposeful and well-conceived.
Empirical vs normative	empirical inquiry asks what is; normative inquiry asks what ought to be.
Political science vs political philosophy	scientific-behavioural studies help find facts and tools, while political philosophy helps determine goals of public policy.
Governance boundary	governance explains delivery mechanisms; this topic uses governance-like evidence only when it sharpens a political concept.

CORE REVISION SPINE

- Heinz Eulau: political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context. (PDF p.139)
- Law/jurisprudence as a data source: distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained.
- Interdisciplinary inquiry widens perspective, helps verify political claims through other social sciences, and also enables political science to contribute back to them. (PDF p.137)
- The chapter argues that single-discipline approaches are partial, whereas an interdisciplinary approach seeks an integrated view of politics. (PDF p.146)
- Empirical orientation, behavioural analysis and systems analysis pushed political science toward other social sciences because real politics cannot be grasped by ideal-state speculation or formal institutions alone. (PDF pp.138-139)
- Interdisciplinary vs random borrowing: Gauba warns that expansion across disciplines must be purposeful and well-conceived. (PDF p.137)
- Aristotle: the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis. (PDF p.146)
- Marx and Engels: Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure. (PDF p.137)
- Show why empirical orientation, behaviouralism and systems analysis pushed political science outward. (PDF pp.138-139)
- Gauba's chapter (PDF pp.141-146) foregrounds history, economics, sociology, psychology and philosophy. A complete interdisciplinary answer should also be able to place anthropology, law and geography on the same map, since these are commonly tested alongside the five above:
- Claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Claim: political order does not require a Weberian state. Evidence: kinship/lineage-based dispute-resolution and authority structures documented across many non-state societies. Significance: tests and refines political theory's core concepts (authority, legitimacy, sovereignty) against non-state cases rather than assuming the modern state is the only unit of analysis. Limit: findings from small-scale societies cannot be mechanically transplanted onto large, complex modern states.
- Claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Claim: legal materials are indispensable evidence for political analysis of institutions and rights. Evidence: constitutional provisions and case law define formal powers, limits and remedies. Significance: grounds political claims about institutional design in verifiable text rather than impression. Limit: legal text alone cannot explain informal power, bargaining or non-compliance - hence the need for sociology/psychology alongside it.

HIGH-RISK TRAPS

- Trap repair: "Interdisciplinary study means political science has lost its identity." -> Gauba says political science remains focused on politics while using other disciplines for broader and better-grounded analysis. (PDF pp.137, 146)
- Trap repair: "Empirical political science made philosophy irrelevant." -> Gauba says political philosophy regained prominence after post-behaviouralism and still helps define policy goals. (PDF pp.145-146)
- Trap repair: "History and political science are the same thing." -> Gauba treats this older formula as an oversimplification; history is used selectively and critically. (PDF p.141)
- Trap repair: "One discipline can fully explain politics." -> The chapter concludes that philosophical, historical, legal, economic, sociological and psychological approaches are partial when used alone. (PDF p.146)

ANSWER SPINE

1. Define the exact doctrine or controversy in the question.
2. State a qualified thesis before narration begins.
3. Reconstruct premises, mechanism and conclusion.
4. Add named thinkers and one precise distinction.
5. Present the strongest objection, reply and residual limitation.
6. End with a graded verdict tied to the directive.